

TIMELINE

- May, 1890** Born in the village of Hoang Tru in Nghe An, central Vietnam, son of an official at the imperial court.
- 1908** Attends Quoc Hoc lycée in Hue.
- 1911** Leaves Vietnam for France, later traveling worldwide on merchant ships.
- 1919** In Paris, he takes the name Nguyen Ai Quoc (the Patriot) and publishes an appeal for Vietnamese rights.
- 1920** Becomes a founder member of the French Communist Party.
- 1923–25** Trained in the Soviet Union as an agent of the Communist International (Comintern), he is sent to Canton, where he founds the Vietnamese Revolutionary Youth League.
- 1926** Marries Zeng Xueming, a Chinese woman, known in Vietnam as Tang Tuyet Minh.
- 1927** Kuomintang suppression of communists forces him to flee China, first for Russia, and then Thailand.
- 1930** Founds the Indochinese Communist Party at a meeting in the British colony of Hong Kong.
- 1931** Arrested by the British authorities in Hong Kong; released in 1933, he leaves for the Soviet Union.
- 1941** Returns to Vietnam and founds the Viet Minh independence movement.
- September 2, 1945** Declares his country independent as the Democratic Republic of Vietnam.
- July 1946** Negotiates with the French at the Fontainebleau conference in France.
- December 1946–August 1954** Leads Vietnam to victory in war against France.
- 1955** Becomes president of North Vietnam.
- 1960** Replaced by Le Duan as head of North Vietnam's ruling communist party.
- 1965** Facing ill-health, he withdraws from involvement in government.
- September 2, 1969** Dies of a heart attack in Hanoi.



HO CHI MINH'S HOUSE IN HANOI, WHERE HE LIVED FROM 1958 UNTIL HIS DEATH